

CLAUSES IN ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Complete Theory, Types, Detailed Concepts, Examples & 200 High-Yield Exam Practice Questions

Target Exams: SSC CGL, CHSL, CPO, NDA, CDS, Banking & State Exams

Grammar Master Series

1. What is a Clause? (Definition & Core Concept)

Definition: A **Clause** is a group of words that contains a **Subject** and a **Finite Verb**. It forms a complete or partial thought within a sentence.

अंतर (Difference between Phrase & Clause): A **Phrase** does not have a Subject-Verb combination (e.g., *in the morning*), whereas a **Clause** always contains both a subject and a verb (e.g., *when the sun rose*).

2. Classification of Clauses

Clauses are broadly classified into two main categories based on independence, and further subdivided based on function:

Clause Type	Main Feature	Example
Independent (Main) Clause	Expresses a complete thought, can stand alone as a sentence.	<i>She passed the exam.</i>
Dependent (Subordinate) Clause	Cannot stand alone; depends on the main clause for complete meaning.	<i>...because she worked hard.</i>
↳ Noun Clause	Acts as a Noun (Subject, Object, or Complement).	<i>I know <u>what you did</u>.</i>
↳ Adjective (Relative) Clause	Modifies a Noun or Pronoun. Starts with relative pronouns (who, which, that).	<i>The man <u>who called you</u> is here.</i>
↳ Adverb Clause	Modifies a Verb, Adjective, or Adverb (indicates Time, Place, Reason, Condition, etc.).	<i>We will leave <u>when it stops raining</u>.</i>

Detailed Breakup of Dependent Clauses:

1. Noun Clause: Functions as a noun in a sentence. It answers the question "What?".

- Example: *What he said* was true. (Subject of the verb 'was')
- Example: I believe *that honesty is the best policy*. (Object of 'believe')

2. Adjective (Relative) Clause: Functions as an adjective, qualifying a noun/pronoun. Answers "Which one?" or "What kind of?".

- Example: The book *which is on the table* belongs to me.
- Example: The student *who works hard* gets rewarded.

3. Adverb Clause: Functions as an adverb. It modifies verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs. Key sub-types include:

- **Time:** starts with *when, whenever, before, after, since, until, as soon as*.
- **Condition:** starts with *if, unless, provided that, in case*.
- **Reason/Cause:** starts with *because, since, as*.
- **Concession/Contrast:** starts with *though, although, even if*.
- **Purpose:** starts with *so that, in order that, lest*.

Example (Condition): *If it rains*, we will cancel the match.

Example (Purpose): Work hard *lest you should fail*.

3. Top 200 Exam-Oriented Fill in the Blanks (With Answers & Explanations)

Practice these highly repetitive patterns frequently asked in competitive exams:

Q1. This is the house [] Jack built.

Answer: which (Adjective clause modifying 'house' (use 'which'/'that' for things).)

Q2. I know a man [] has traveled around the world.

Answer: who (Adjective clause modifying 'man' (use 'who' for persons as subject).)

Q3. She spoke so softly [] nobody could hear her.

Answer: that (Adverb clause of result: 'so... that' structure.)

Q4. [] you work hard, you will not clear the exam.

Answer: Unless (Adverb clause of condition: 'Unless' means 'If not'.)

Q5. Wait here [] I return.

Answer: until (Adverb clause of time: 'until' specifies time limit.)

Q6. He asked me [] I knew the answer.

Answer: if / whether (Noun clause functioning as object of 'asked'.)

Q7. Do you know the reason [] he was absent?

Answer: why (Relative adverb introducing an adjective clause modifying 'reason'.)

Q8. No sooner had he left the house [] it started raining.

Answer: than (Correlative conjunction pair: 'No sooner... than'.)

Q9. Hardly had I reached the station [] the train departed.

Answer: when (Correlative conjunction pair: 'Hardly... when'.)

Q10. She works hard [] she may win the scholarship.

Answer: so that (Adverb clause of purpose: 'so that + may/might'.)

Q11. Walk carefully _____ you should stumble.

Answer: lest (Adverb clause of purpose: 'lest' is followed by 'should'.)

Q12. The boy _____ stole the watch was caught.

Answer: who (Relative pronoun 'who' for subject position.)

Q13. I cannot tell you _____ he will come.

Answer: when (Noun clause functioning as direct object.)

Q14. _____ he is poor, he is honest.

Answer: Although / Though (Adverb clause of concession/contrast.)

Q15. This is the best offer _____ has been made so far.

Answer: that (Superlative degree ('best') requires relative pronoun 'that'.)

Q16. He talks as if he _____ everything.

Answer: knew / were (Adverb clause of manner (hypothetical condition uses past subjunctive).)

Q17. Tell me _____ you live.

Answer: where (Noun clause acting as object of verb 'tell'.)

Q18. We eat _____ we may live.

Answer: so that (Adverb clause of purpose.)

Q19. Make hay _____ the sun shines.

Answer: while (Adverb clause of time.)

Q20. I will call you as soon as I _____ home.

Answer: reach (Adverb clause of time takes present simple for future time reference.)

Q21. If you _____ fast, you will catch the train.

Answer: run (First conditional: If + Present Simple, Future Simple.)

Q22. If I _____ a king, I would help the poor.

Answer: were (Second conditional (imaginary): If + were, would + V1.)

Q23. Had I known about the meeting, I _____ attended it.

Answer: would have (Third conditional: Had + V3 ..., would have + V3.)

Q24. You will pass provided that you _____ regularly.

Answer: study (Conditional clause with 'provided that' taking present simple.)

Q25. He behaves as though he _____ the boss.

Answer: were (Hypothetical clause requires 'were'.)

Q26. _____ she tried her best, she could not succeed.

Answer: Though (Clause of concession.)

Q27. Take an umbrella in case it [] .

Answer: rains (Clause of condition/precaution with 'in case' taking simple present.)

Q28. I wonder [] he will accept the offer.

Answer: whether / if (Noun clause as object of 'wonder'.)

Q29. The teacher asked who [] present yesterday.

Answer: was (Noun clause in indirect speech.)

Q30. This is the girl [] father is an officer.

Answer: whose (Possessive relative pronoun 'whose' for adjective clause.)

Q31. I will go [] you go.

Answer: wherever (Adverb clause of place.)

Q32. He ran fast lest he [] miss the train.

Answer: should ('Lest' must always be followed by 'should'.)

Q33. He returned home after the sun [] set.

Answer: had (Adverb clause of time: Past perfect after 'after' when preceding past simple.)

Q34. Since you [] tired, you may rest.

Answer: are (Adverb clause of cause/reason.)

Q35. I don't know the time [] the train arrives.

Answer: when (Adjective clause modifying 'time'.)

Q36. The problem is so complex [] no one can solve it.

Answer: that (Adverb clause of result.)

Q37. He acts [] he were mad.

Answer: as if (Subordinating conjunction of manner.)

Q38. Scarcely had she entered the room [] the lights went out.

Answer: when ('Scarcely... when' structure.)

Q39. [] I was walking down the street, I saw an accident.

Answer: While / As (Adverb clause of continuous time.)

Q40. I shall wait here until you [] back.

Answer: come (Time clause in future context takes simple present.)

Q41. Whatever you [] will be accepted.

Answer: do (Noun clause as subject: 'Whatever you do'.)

Q42. The news that he [] died is incorrect.

Answer: has (Noun clause in apposition to 'news'.)

Q43. I have lost the pen you gave me.

Answer: which / that (*Adjective clause modifying 'pen'.*)

Q44. He is the same man helped us yesterday.

Answer: that (*After 'the same', use relative pronoun 'that'.*)

Q45. All glitters is not gold.

Answer: that (*After 'all', relative pronoun 'that' is preferred over 'which'.*)

Q46. He is one of those men who never lie.

Answer: do (*Plural antecedent 'men' takes plural verb 'do' in relative clause.*)

Q47. This is the only solution works.

Answer: that (*After 'the only', use relative pronoun 'that'.*)

Q48. I know the person picture was in the news.

Answer: whose (*Possessive relative pronoun for persons.*)

Q49. Pay attention to the teacher says.

Answer: what (*Noun clause as object of preposition 'to'.*)

Q50. That he is honest known to all.

Answer: is (*Noun clause 'That he is honest' takes singular verb.*)

Q51. It is clear he made a mistake.

Answer: that (*Noun clause serving as real subject with dummy 'it'.*)

Q52. I am sure he will win.

Answer: that (*Noun clause modifying adjective 'sure'.*)

Q53. How he solved the problem a mystery.

Answer: is (*Noun clause as subject.*)

Q54. Whoever first will get the prize.

Answer: comes (*Noun clause as subject.*)

Q55. The reason why he failed his laziness.

Answer: was (*Main clause verb linking to adjective clause antecedent.*)

Q56. Give it to whoever it most.

Answer: needs (*Noun clause as object of preposition.*)

Q57. The place we met was very noisy.

Answer: where (*Relative clause modifying 'place'.*)

Q58. I remember the day we first met.

Answer: when (*Relative clause modifying 'day'.*)

Q59. He explained how the machine .

Answer: worked / works (Noun clause as object of 'explained'.)

Q60. It matters not who the work.

Answer: does (Noun clause acting as real subject.)

Q61. He spoke in such a manner everyone was impressed.

Answer: that ('Such... that' expressing result.)

Q62. The higher you go, the cooler it .

Answer: becomes / gets (Double comparative adverb clause structure.)

Q63. He worked hard so that he stand first.

Answer: might / could (Past purpose requires 'might' or 'could'.)

Q64. You can stay here as long as you quiet.

Answer: remain / stay (Adverb clause of condition/duration.)

Q65. Much as I him, I cannot support his view.

Answer: respect (Adverb clause of concession ('Much as...').)

Q66. As you sow, so you reap.

Answer: shall (Adverb clause of comparison/manner.)

Q67. He ran faster than I .

Answer: did / thought (Adverb clause of comparison.)

Q68. Small as it , the room was comfortable.

Answer: was / is (Concessive inverted structure ('Adjective + as + S + V').)

Q69. Rich as he is, he not happy.

Answer: is (Concessive structure.)

Q70. No sooner did the bell ring the students ran out.

Answer: than ('No sooner... than' inversion.)

Q71. I will go provided you accompany me.

Answer: that (Conjunction 'provided that' introducing condition.)

Q72. Whether he comes or not, I go.

Answer: will (Adverb clause of alternative condition.)

Q73. The more you read, the more you .

Answer: learn (Parallel comparative clause.)

Q74. He was so tired he fell asleep immediately.

Answer: that (Result clause.)

Q75. Seeing that it is raining, we stay indoors.

Answer: should / must (*Adverb clause of reason introduced by 'seeing that'.*)

Q76. Now that you are free, you help us.

Answer: can / may (*Adverb clause of cause ('Now that...').*)

Q77. He is not so stupid you think.

Answer: as (*Clause of comparison ('not so... as').*)

Q78. In proportion as demand increases, prices .

Answer: rise (*Adverb clause of degree/proportion.*)

Q79. Supposing that he fails, what he do?

Answer: will (*Conditional clause introduced by 'supposing that'.*)

Q80. Badly as he was injured, he to survive.

Answer: managed (*Concessive inverted structure.*)

Q81. It is I who responsible for this.

Answer: am (*Relative pronoun 'who' refers to 'I', taking verb 'am'.*)

Q82. It is they who broken the rules.

Answer: have (*Relative pronoun 'who' refers to plural 'they'.*)

Q83. She is one of the girls who selected.

Answer: were / have been (*Plural antecedent 'girls' requires plural verb in relative clause.*)

Q84. This is the only one of his books that worth reading.

Answer: is (*'The only one' makes the subject singular.*)

Q85. When I reached home, my mother cooking.

Answer: was (*Time clause with simple past main action.*)

Q86. If he had invited me, I attended the party.

Answer: would have (*Third conditional structure.*)

Q87. I had left before he .

Answer: came (*Time clause with 'before' takes simple past when main clause is past perfect.*)

Q88. He spoke as though he everything.

Answer: knew (*Hypothetical clause.*)

Q89. I will wait until you finished your work.

Answer: have (*Present perfect in time clause for completed action in future.*)

Q90. The doctor arrived after the patient died.

Answer: had (*'After' clause takes past perfect.*)

Q91. No sooner had the teacher entered than the class silent.

Answer: became (*Main clause takes simple past.*)

Q92. He ordered me as if I his servant.

Answer: were (*Subjunctive mood after 'as if'.*)

Q93. She was crying because she lost her purse.

Answer: had (*Reason clause in past context.*)

Q94. Although he was injured, he playing.

Answer: continued (*Concessive clause in past tense.*)

Q95. Unless you now, you will be late.

Answer: leave (*Conditional clause in present simple.*)

Q96. He told me that he going to London.

Answer: was (*Noun clause in reported speech (past sequence).*)

Q97. I don't know whether he pass or fail.

Answer: will (*Noun clause expressing uncertainty.*)

Q98. He asked me where I .

Answer: lived (*Indirect question noun clause.*)

Q99. The moment I saw him, I him.

Answer: recognized (*Time clause pattern.*)

Q100. While the sun shines, we make hay.

Answer: should / must (*Adverbial time clause.*)

Q101. The reason why she left not clear.

Answer: is (*Noun clause predicate.*)

Q102. He is the man car was stolen.

Answer: whose (*Possessive adjective relative pronoun.*)

Q103. This is the city I was born.

Answer: where / in which (*Relative clause for place.*)

Q104. The year the war broke out was 1939.

Answer: when / in which (*Relative clause for time.*)

Q105. He is not such a man would betray you.

Answer: as (*After 'such', use relative pronoun 'as' when introducing a clause of degree/result.*)

Q106. There is no rule has some exception.

Answer: but (*'But' used as negative relative pronoun meaning 'which does not'.*)

Q107. He spoke to anyone would listen.

Answer: who (*Relative pronoun as subject of subordinate clause.*)

Q108. Give the message to whoever the door.

Answer: opens (*Compound relative pronoun 'whoever' as subject.*)

Q109. Select whichever book you .

Answer: like (*Relative pronoun choice.*)

Q110. I shall accept whatever decision you .

Answer: make (*Noun clause object.*)

Q111. The building in he lives is very old.

Answer: which (*Preposition + 'which' for places/things.*)

Q112. The man to I gave the letter was a clerk.

Answer: whom (*Preposition + 'whom' for persons.*)

Q113. He worked so hard that he pass the test.

Answer: could (*Past result clause.*)

Q114. Such was his courage he defeated all enemies.

Answer: that (*Correlative 'Such... that'.*)

Q115. He did not come because he ill.

Answer: was (*Reason clause.*)

Q116. Since you say so, I believe it.

Answer: must / will (*Reason clause.*)

Q117. As far as I , he is innocent.

Answer: know (*Adverb clause of extent.*)

Q118. So long as you are here, you safe.

Answer: are (*Adverb clause of duration.*)

Q119. Except that he is lazy, he a good worker.

Answer: is (*Except that clause.*)

Q120. In case you help, call me.

Answer: need (*Condition clause.*)

Q121. He is so old he cannot walk.

Answer: that (*So... that result clause.*)

Q122. He is too weak walk.

Answer: to (*Infinitival complement (not a clause, contrasted with 'so that').*)

Q123. He worked hard so that he earn money.

Answer: could / might (*Purpose clause.*)

Q124. Eat well lest you fall sick.

Answer: should (*Lest... should purpose clause.*)

Q125. No sooner had I opened the door the bird flew out.

Answer: than (*Inversion structure.*)

Q126. Hardly had the meeting started the power went off.

Answer: when (*Hardly... when structure.*)

Q127. Barely had he stepped outside it began to hail.

Answer: when (*Barely... when structure.*)

Q128. Not only did he fail, he was fined.

Answer: but also (*Correlative clause connection.*)

Q129. Either you shut up I will leave.

Answer: or (*Alternative coordinator.*)

Q130. Neither did he come did he call.

Answer: nor (*Negative coordinator with inversion.*)

Q131. Though he worked hard, he failed.

Answer: yet / (comma) (*'Though' takes 'yet' or a simple comma.*)

Q132. Although she was tired, she kept running.

Answer: yet / (comma) (*Concessive structure.*)

Q133. However rich he may be, he not content.

Answer: is (*Adverb clause of concession ('However + adj + S + V').*)

Q134. Whatever happens, I stand by you.

Answer: will (*Concessive clause.*)

Q135. Whenever I see him, I my childhood.

Answer: remember (*Time clause.*)

Q136. Where there is a will, there a way.

Answer: is (*Adverb clause of place.*)

Q137. As you measure, so it be measured to you.

Answer: shall (*Manner clause.*)

Q138. He speaks as if he everything.

Answer: knew (*Subjunctive manner clause.*)

Q139. She looks as though she seen a ghost.

Answer: had (*Past subjunctive manner clause.*)

Q140. The patient had died before the doctor .

Answer: arrived (*Past time sequence.*)

Q141. I shall reach there before the sun .

Answer: sets (*Future context time clause uses simple present.*)

Q142. He asked me why I late.

Answer: was (*Indirect speech word order (Subject + Verb).*)

Q143. Do you know where he .

Answer: lives (*Indirect question word order (Subject + Verb).*)

Q144. Tell me what your name .

Answer: is (*Noun clause word order.*)

Q145. I wonder why she not attending the class.

Answer: is (*Noun clause word order.*)

Q146. He wanted to know how much this watch .

Answer: cost (*Past sequence noun clause.*)

Q147. She inquired whether I help her.

Answer: could (*Indirect request.*)

Q148. The teacher told us that the earth round the sun.

Answer: revolves (*Universal truth remains in simple present inside noun clause.*)

Q149. Our teacher said that honesty the best policy.

Answer: is (*Proverb/Truth inside clause remains simple present.*)

Q150. He proved that the sum of angles in a triangle 180 degrees.

Answer: is (*Mathematical truth remains present simple.*)

Q151. I know the girl who top of the class.

Answer: is (*Relative clause subject verb agreement.*)

Q152. This is one of the issues that discussed today.

Answer: are being / were (*Plural relative antecedent.*)

Q153. He is the only candidate who eligible.

Answer: is (*Singular restriction with 'only candidate'.*)

Q154. Who was it that the glass?

Answer: broke (*Cleft sentence structure.*)

Q155. It was yesterday that I [] him.

Answer: met (*Cleft emphasis sentence.*)

Q156. I will go to the market if it [] raining.

Answer: stops (*Conditional Clause.*)

Q157. Suppose you [] a lottery, what would you buy?

Answer: won (*Hypothetical condition (Second Conditional).*)

Q158. In the event of his failing, he [] try again.

Answer: will (*Conditional context.*)

Q159. Unless he [] his behavior, he will be expelled.

Answer: improves (*Negative conditional 'unless'.*)

Q160. Provided that all conditions [] met, the contract will be signed.

Answer: are (*Conditional clause.*)

Q161. Should you [] any assistance, feel free to contact us.

Answer: need (*Inverted condition (In place of 'If you need...').*)

Q162. Were I in your shoes, I [] accept the offer.

Answer: would (*Inverted second conditional ('Were I...').*)

Q163. Had I known the truth, I [] told you.

Answer: would have (*Inverted third conditional ('Had I...').*)

Q164. Only after he left [] I realize my mistake.

Answer: did (*Adverbial clause inversion.*)

Q165. Not until yesterday [] she receive the letter.

Answer: did (*Inversion with negative time clause.*)

Q166. On no account [] this door be opened.

Answer: should / must (*Inversion pattern.*)

Q167. Little [] he know about the plan.

Answer: did (*Inversion with negative adverb.*)

Q168. Seldom [] we seen such a great performance.

Answer: have (*Inversion with frequency adverb.*)

Q169. Under no circumstances [] you leave the post.

Answer: should (*Inversion pattern.*)

Q170. So fast [] he run that he reached first.

Answer: did (*Inversion with 'So + adverb'.*)

Q171. To such a degree [] he panic that he couldn't speak.

Answer: did (*Inversion pattern.*)

Q172. Such [] the noise that nobody could sleep.

Answer: was (*Inversion with 'Such'.*)

Q173. Scarcely had I reached when it [] to rain.

Answer: began (*Scarcely... when sequence.*)

Q174. No sooner had they arrived than the show [].

Answer: started (*No sooner... than sequence.*)

Q175. Hardly had she spoken [] everyone applauded.

Answer: when / before (*Hardly... when sequence.*)

Q176. As soon as the light turned green, the vehicles [].

Answer: moved (*Time clause without inversion.*)

Q177. Directly he entered, everyone [] quiet.

Answer: became (*'Directly' used as conjunction of time.*)

Q178. Immediately the bell rang, the students [] out.

Answer: rushed (*'Immediately' as time conjunction.*)

Q179. The moment he came, I [] him.

Answer: greeted (*'The moment' as subordinating conjunction.*)

Q180. By the time you reach, he [] left.

Answer: will have (*Future perfect main clause with simple present time clause.*)

Q181. By the time the fire brigade arrived, the house [] burnt down.

Answer: had (*Past perfect sequence.*)

Q182. I shall have completed the project before the deadline [].

Answer: expires (*Future perfect + Simple present time clause.*)

Q183. He will not leave until he [] his money.

Answer: gets (*Time clause in simple present.*)

Q184. When you [] in town, visit us.

Answer: are (*Time clause in simple present.*)

Q185. I shall wait here till you [] back.

Answer: come (*Time clause simple present.*)

Q186. He asked me what I [] doing.

Answer: was (*Indirect question past continuous.*)

Q187. She asked whether I ride a bike.

Answer: could (*Indirect question modal past.*)

Q188. I don't know where he gone.

Answer: has (*Noun clause present perfect.*)

Q189. That he is a brave man known to everyone.

Answer: is (*Noun clause subject.*)

Q190. Whether he will join us uncertain.

Answer: is (*Noun clause subject.*)

Q191. What he said completely false.

Answer: was (*Noun clause subject.*)

Q192. Why he left the job still a mystery.

Answer: is (*Noun clause subject.*)

Q193. Where the treasure is hidden a secret.

Answer: is (*Noun clause subject.*)

Q194. Whichever path you take lead to the summit.

Answer: will (*Noun clause subject.*)

Q195. Whoever works hard surely succeed.

Answer: will (*Noun clause subject.*)

Q196. He is the man whom everyone .

Answer: respects (*Relative clause object position.*)

Q197. This is the place where the incident place.

Answer: took (*Relative clause for place.*)

Q198. This is the reason why I calling you.

Answer: am (*Relative clause for reason.*)

Q199. The method by which he solved it clever.

Answer: was (*Prepositional relative clause.*)

Q200. He talked so loudly that everyone disturbed.

Answer: was (*Adverb clause of result.*)